

Greek Root gen-

I can use gen- to understand words about beginnings and families.

Today I am learning to:

- ☐ understand the root
- ☐ build root-family words
- ☐ match words to meanings
- ☐ use the words in context

1 Discover the Meaning

The Greek root gen- connects to birth, origin or kind.
These words help us explore beginnings, families and inherited traits.



genesis

the beginning or origin of something



gene

a part of DNA that helps shape inherited traits



genetics

the study of inherited traits



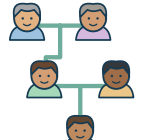
geneticist

a scientist who studies genes and inheritance



genome

a living thing's complete set of genetic material



genealogy

the study of family history and ancestors

2 Complete the Words

Write gen to complete each word.

- _____esis (a beginning)
- _____e (a part of DNA)
- _____etics (study of inherited traits)
- _____eticist (a scientist studying genes)
- _____ome (all genetic material)
- _____ealogy (study of family history)

3 Choose the Meaning

Tick the best meaning for each word.

- | | | |
|----------------------|--|--|
| 1. genesis | ☐ a beginning or origin | ☐ a final result |
| 2. gene | ☐ a whole family tree | ☐ part of DNA with instructions |
| 3. genetics | ☐ study of inherited traits | ☐ study of rocks |
| 4. geneticist | ☐ a plant's full set of DNA | ☐ a scientist who studies genes |
| 5. genome | ☐ one inherited trait | ☐ all genetic material |
| 6. genealogy | ☐ study of family history | ☐ study of living cells |

4 Match the Word to the Picture

Draw a line from each word to its picture.

genesis

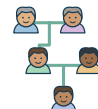
gene

genetics

geneticist

genome

genealogy



5 Use the Words

Use each word once to complete the sentences.

genesis
geneticist

gene
genome

genetics
genealogy

- A _____ carries instructions in DNA.
- _____ is the study of inherited traits.
- A _____ studies genes and inheritance.
- A living thing's full DNA set is its _____.
- That first idea was the _____ of our story.
- We traced our ancestors through _____.

6 ★ Challenge!

Choose one word. Explain how birth or origin helps you understand it. Then draw a matching picture.

Draw your picture here!



You did it!

I can use word parts to unlock meanings.

gen-: birth, origin or kind